

3.1.2 Price determination in a competitive market

3.1.2.1 The determinants of the demand for goods and services

Content	Additional information
• The factors which determine the demand for a good or service. • A demand curve shows the relationship between price and quantity demanded. • The causes of shifts in the demand curve.	Students should understand the factors that influence the spending decisions of consumers, including: price, income, wealth, the price of substitutes and complementary goods, and individual preferences. They should also appreciate that such decisions are influenced by social and emotional factors.

3.1.2.2 Price, income and cross elasticities of demand

Content	Additional information
• Be able to calculate price, income and cross elasticities of demand. • The relationship between income elasticity of demand and normal and inferior goods. • The relationship between cross elasticity of demand and substitute and complementary goods. • The relationships between price elasticity of demand and firms' total revenue (total expenditure). • The factors that influence these elasticities of demand.	Students should be able to interpret numerical values of these elasticities of demand.

3.1.2.3 The determinants of the supply of goods and services

Content	Additional information
• The factors which determine the supply of a good or service. • A supply curve shows the relationship between price and quantity supplied. • Understand higher prices imply higher profits and that this will provide the incentive to expand production. • The causes of shifts in the supply curve.	

3.1.2.4 Price elasticity of supply

Content	Additional information
• Be able to calculate price elasticity of supply. • The factors that influence price elasticity of supply.	Students should be able to interpret numerical values of price elasticity of supply.

3.1.2.5 The determination of equilibrium market prices

Content	Additional information
• How the interaction of demand and supply determines equilibrium prices in a market economy. • The difference between equilibrium and disequilibrium. • Why excess demand and excess supply lead to changes in price.	Students should be able to use demand and supply diagrams to help them to analyse causes of changes in equilibrium market prices. They should be able to apply their knowledge of the basic model of demand and supply to a variety of real-world markets.

3.1.2.6 The interrelationship between markets

Content	Additional information
• Changes in a particular market are likely to affect other markets. • The implications of joint demand, demand for substitute goods, composite demand, derived demand and joint supply.	Students should, for example, be able to explore the impact of changes in demand, supply and price in one market upon other related markets.